

NAME

darkcombine -- Combine and process dark count images

USAGE

darkcombine input

PARAMETERS**input**

List of dark count images to combine. The *ccdtype* parameter may be used to select the zero level images from a list containing all types of data.

output = "Dark"

Output dark count root image name.

combine = "average" (average|median)

Type of combining operation performed on the final set of pixels (after rejection). The choices are "average" or "median". The median uses the average of the two central values when the number of pixels is even.

reject = "minmax" (none|minmax|ccdclip|crreject|sigclip|avsigclip|pclip)

Type of rejection operation. See **combine** for details.

ccdtype = "dark"

CCD image type to combine. If no image type is given then all input images are combined.

process = yes

Process the input images before combining?

delete = no

Delete input images after combining? Only those images combined are deleted.

clobber = no

Clobber existing output images?

scale = "exposure" (none|mode|median|mean|exposure)

Multiplicative image scaling to be applied. The choices are none, scale by the mode, median, or mean of the specified statistics section, or scale by the exposure time given in the image header.

statsec = ""

Section of images to use in computing image statistics for scaling. If no section is given then the entire region of the image is sampled (for efficiency the images are sampled if they are big enough).

Algorithm Parameters**nlow = 0, nhigh = 1 (minmax)**

The number of low and high pixels to be rejected by the "minmax" algorithm.

nkeep = 1

The minimum number of pixels to retain or the maximum number to reject when using the clipping algorithms (ccdclip, crreject, sigclip, avsigclip, or pclip). When given as a positive value this is the minimum number to keep. When given as a negative value the absolute value is the maximum

number to reject. This is actually converted to a number to keep by adding it to the number of images.

mclip = yes (ccdclip, crreject, sigclip, avsigclip)

Use the median as the estimate for the true intensity rather than the average with high and low values excluded in the "ccdclip", "crreject", "sigclip", and "avsigclip" algorithms? The median is a better estimator in the presence of data which one wants to reject than the average. However, computing the median is slower than the average.

lsigma = 3., hsigma = 3. (ccdclip, crreject, sigclip, avsigclip, pclip)

Low and high sigma clipping factors for the "ccdclip", "crreject", "sigclip", "avsigclip", and "pclip" algorithms. They multiply a "sigma" factor produced by the algorithm to select a point below and above the average or median value for rejecting pixels. The lower sigma is ignored for the "crreject" algorithm.

rdnoise = "0.", gain = "1.", snoise = "0." (ccdclip, crreject)

CCD readout noise in electrons, gain in electrons/DN, and sensitivity noise as a fraction. These parameters are used with the "ccdclip" and "crreject" algorithms. The values may be either numeric or an image header keyword which contains the value.

pclip = -0.5 (pclip)

Percentile clipping algorithm parameter. If greater than one in absolute value then it specifies a number of pixels above or below the median to use for computing the clipping sigma. If less than one in absolute value then it specifies the fraction of the pixels above or below the median to use. A positive value selects a point above the median and a negative value selects a point below the median. The default of -0.5 selects approximately the quartile point. See **combine** for further details.

blank = 0.

Output value to be used when there are no pixels.

DESCRIPTION

The dark count images in the input image list are combined. The input images may be processed first if desired. The original images may be deleted automatically if desired. The output pixel datatype will be real.

This task is a script which applies **ccdproc** and **combine**. The parameters and combining algorithms are described in detail in the help for **combine**. This script has default parameters specifically set for dark count images and simplifies the combining parameters. There are other combining options not included in this task. For these additional features, such as thresholding, offsetting, masking, and projecting, use **combine**.

EXAMPLES

1. The image data contains four dark count images. To automatically select them and combine them as a background job using the default combining algorithm:

```
cl> darkcombine ccd*.imh&
```

SEE ALSO

ccdproc, combine